

IN TEST: 16 FLATBED SCANNERS



THROW A SCANNER IN YOUR WORKS

Choose one from among our recommendations and liven up your reports and presentations with distinctive images

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More Info on
the test process and the
products tested, check out
Mindware

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With innumerable free Web services and 'get-your-Web-site-up-in-five-minutes' software, the need for affordable imaging solutions is very apparent. The good news is that a plethora of such solutions are now available and you can choose from among them depending on your application.

With a scanner, you can port all those birthday and family photos over to your personal Web site. Apart from working with just images, if you buy a scanner with OCR capabilities, you can also scan documents and text from newspapers and magazines.

The latest scanners offer a host of features such as Scan-to-Web and Scan-to-e-mail. The Scan-to-Web function enables you to post images to your Web site at the touch of a button, while the Scan-to-e-mail feature allows you to e-mail an image directly—you don't have to separately import it into your e-mail client.

Apart from the enhanced functionality,

today's scanners are sleeker and smaller than their predecessors, so you don't have to allot half of your desktop space to your new scanner.

Speed test

The speed of each scanner was first tested using a simple text document created in the lab, which contained both text and a company logo.

This document was previewed using the Twain drivers that came with each scanner, and the timing was logged using a stopwatch. Here, we logged the duration between the moment the Preview button was pressed and the moment the image appeared in Photoshop.

The fastest preview was generated by the Epson 1640 SU, which uses Twain 5 drivers developed by the same vendor. The scanner took only 5.58 seconds to preview the document at 300 dpi in true colour. The other impressive performers in the preview test were the Microtek ScanMaker 3600, which took 8.58 seconds, and the Epson 1240U Photo (9.31 seconds).